

Northwind Remote Work Handbook

Policies for employees working remotely at Northwind Ltd. Last reviewed March 2026.

Questions about anything not covered here go to your line manager.

Expenses and reimbursement

Employees may claim reimbursement for equipment, software licenses and co-working space. Claims must be submitted within 60 days of purchase, and **reimbursement is paid within 30 days of an approved claim**. Claims over £500 require written approval from a line manager before the purchase is made, not after.

Receipts are required for every claim regardless of value. A bank statement is not a receipt. Claims submitted without a receipt are returned rather than rejected, and the 60-day window pauses while a claim sits with the employee.

Reimbursement is paid through payroll and appears as a separate line on the monthly statement. It is not taxed as income. Claims approved after the payroll cut-off, which is the 18th of each month, are paid in the following cycle rather than held.

Equipment

Every remote employee receives a laptop, an external monitor and a desk chair. The company retains ownership of equipment for three years, after which it transfers to the employee at no cost. Equipment that fails within the three-year period is replaced rather than repaired.

Employees may choose between a 14-inch and a 16-inch laptop. The choice is made once at onboarding and cannot be changed until the three-year refresh.

Peripherals beyond the standard set — a second monitor, a standing desk, an ergonomic keyboard — are claimed as expenses rather than issued, and follow the reimbursement rules above. A desk assessment is offered at onboarding and again on request.

Working hours and availability

There are no fixed working hours. Employees are asked to overlap with their team for at least four hours per day, and to record those overlap hours in the shared calendar. Meetings scheduled outside a colleague's recorded overlap hours may be declined without explanation.

Response time expectations are one working day for messages and three working days for document review. Nothing in this handbook requires a response outside working hours.

Employees working from a timezone more than six hours from their team's registered location need their line manager's agreement, reviewed every six months. The agreement covers the overlap requirement above and nothing else.

Time off

Annual leave is 28 days plus public holidays, and unused leave does not carry over. Leave requests of five days or fewer are approved automatically. Longer requests need a line manager's approval and at least three weeks' notice.

Sick leave is not counted against annual leave and does not require a medical certificate for absences of seven days or fewer.

Public holidays follow the employee's country of residence rather than the company's registered office. An employee who works a public holiday may take the day back within the same quarter.

Travel

Travel to a company office is booked through the travel desk and does not need a claim. Anything booked directly is treated as an expense and follows the reimbursement rules, including the receipt requirement.

Rail is the default for journeys under five hours. Flights over five hours are booked in premium economy where the fare difference is under £300. Hotel bookings are capped at £180 per night outside London and £240 within it.

Time spent travelling during working hours counts as working time. Time spent travelling outside them does not, and is taken back as time off in lieu within the following month.

Data handling

Company documents may not be uploaded to third-party services that have not been approved by the security team. The approved list is maintained in the internal wiki and reviewed quarterly. Personal accounts may not be used for company work, including cloud storage and note-taking applications.

Laptops must have full-disk encryption enabled. This is checked automatically at onboarding and cannot be disabled.

Documents classified as restricted may not leave company-managed devices at all. Where a document's classification is unclear, treat it as restricted and ask the security team, who answer within one working day.

Leaving the company

Equipment is returned within ten working days of the final day, using a prepaid shipping label issued by the IT team. Equipment older than three years has already transferred to the employee and is not returned.

Outstanding expense claims must be submitted before the final day. Claims received afterwards are paid at the company's discretion and are not covered by the 30-day commitment above.